

Text structure - Workbook 2

Focused practice - Workbook 2 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Bike Share Expansion

First, the city added stations near two train stops. After three months, planners reviewed trip data and moved one low-use station. Finally, they added stations near a college and a hospital.

1. Which text structure best describes this passage?

- A. sequence / process
- B. cause / effect
- C. compare / contrast
- D. problem / solution

2. How does that structure help develop the passage?

- A. It hides the relationship among the main ideas.
- B. Chronological order shows how the program was adjusted step by step using new information.
- C. It arranges details without helping readers understand how they connect.
- D. It mainly creates suspense rather than explaining the topic.

Reusable Containers

A cafeteria wants to reduce disposable packaging. One option is to charge a deposit for reusable containers; another is to let students bring their own. The report weighs cleaning needs, convenience, and cost before recommending a small deposit program.

3. Which text structure best describes this passage?

- A. cause / effect
- B. sequence / process
- C. compare / contrast leading to recommendation
- D. classification only

4. How does that structure help develop the passage?

- A. It hides the relationship among the main ideas.
- B. It arranges details without helping readers understand how they connect.
- C. It mainly creates suspense rather than explaining the topic.
- D. The comparison lets the report evaluate alternatives using the same criteria before choosing one.

Floodplain Houses

A river naturally spreads onto its floodplain during heavy rain. When buildings and pavement replace absorbent soil, less water soaks into the ground and runoff reaches the river faster. Flood peaks can therefore rise more quickly.

5. Which text structure best describes this passage?

- A. cause / effect
- B. compare / contrast
- C. sequence / process
- D. classification / description

6. How does that structure help develop the passage?

- A. It hides the relationship among the main ideas.
- B. The structure explains how land-use changes contribute to faster and higher flood peaks.
- C. It arranges details without helping readers understand how they connect.
- D. It mainly creates suspense rather than explaining the topic.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The ideas are organized as sequence / process.
2. B. Chronological order shows how the program was adjusted step by step using new information.
3. C. The ideas are organized as compare / contrast leading to recommendation.
4. D. The comparison lets the report evaluate alternatives using the same criteria before choosing one.
5. A. The ideas are organized as cause / effect.
6. B. The structure explains how land-use changes contribute to faster and higher flood peaks.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.